

Problem 5. Tangkhul Kinship Terms

Solution:

A]

i	=I (Since Achui is talking to Tsimik about her relations).
aavu	=mother
aachon	=elder sister
atsarvu	=younger sister
naaongalaavu	=daughter
naaomayarri	=son
aavaa	=father
aanyi	=mother-in-law
aawo	=father-in-law
na	=you

Achui is Tsimik's mother and from (10), she seems to be the mother of H as well. But if so, H must be the daughter of D, which is not the case (from 11), since irri is not a word for daughter. Let us assume that irri= niece.

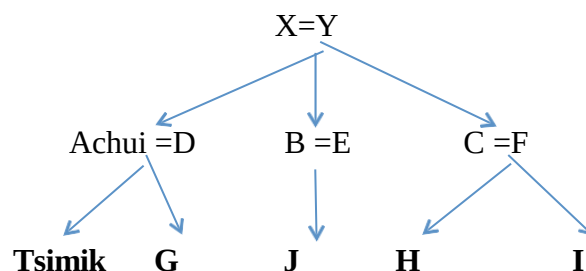
G is Tsimik's younger sister, while H is I's elder sister. Then G and Tsimik are brother and sister, and are Achui and D's children. H and I are sisters. I being C's daughter (sentence 14) both H and I are C and F's daughters.

J is Achui's as well as C's niece (sentences 16 & 20), which means J is a daughter of B and E.

The sentence 17 again says that D is I's father! But given that H and I are sisters and H is a niece of D, D cannot be the father of these two.

It must be, that in this language, maternal aunty and her husband are also called as Aavuu and Aavaa(mother and father).

So the solution to the QA is:



B]

1= naaongalaavu (from sentence 4 naaoglaavu =daughter). 2= aavaa (from sentence 17, aavaa =maternal aunty's husband (uncle)). 3= aawo (reasoning: from sentence 8, Aawo = father in law). 4= aavu (from sentence 10, aavu =maternal aunty). 5.aarri (from sentence 15, aarri =nephew).